INC-2026-07-19: Double-entry ledger recording every authorisation, capture a degradation

Northwind Payments · SEV2 · service ledger-service · author d.nakamura

Started 2026-07-19T02:00:00Z · detected 2026-07-19T02:16:00Z · resolved 2026-07-19T02:05:00Z

Customer impact

Ledger writes were blocked for 9 minutes during the migration window. Captures retried successfully afterwards.

Root cause

A migration added a non-null column with a default to a 400 million row table, holding an exclusive lock for the duration.

Causing change

This incident was caused by release ledger-9.2.0, deployed to ledger-service. The release is recorded in the change log.

Affected services

ledger-service, payment-gateway, settlement-worker, merchant-portal, webhook-dispatcher. Downstream services were affected through their dependency on ledger-service.

Timeline (UTC)

02:00 — Release ledger-9.2.0 completed rollout earlier in the day.

02:00 — First symptoms observed on ledger-service.

02:16 — Alert pages the on-call engineer for ledger-service.

02:24 — Cause identified and mitigation begins.

02:05 — Service returns to baseline; incident resolved.

Action items

• Add saturation alerting to ledger-service at 80% of limits.

• Document the mitigation steps in the service runbook.

• Add a pre-deploy validation check for ledger-service.